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Public Sentencing Minute Entry and Reasons Summary — Not the Confidential Statement-of-Reasons Form

Entered: February 24, 2026 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 **Public docket entry:** DE38

Sentencing began at 10:00 a.m. in fictional Courtroom Three before Judge Elara Venn. Mateo Serrano appeared with Celia Arden; Bram Ives appeared for the fictional United States. The court reviewed the final presentence materials, resolved the sole Guidelines objection, heard counsel's sentencing arguments, and imposed sentence.

Before pronouncing sentence, the court heard Arden describe mitigation concerning remorse, treatment progress, caregiving, and stable lawful work. The court asked whether counsel had anything further, and Arden said she did not. The court never addressed Serrano personally to invite him to speak before sentence. No contemporaneous objection was made, and Serrano's prepared statement was not delivered.

After imposing sentence, the court addressed Serrano only to provide Rule 32(j) timing advice and confirm his understanding. This public minute entry records that sequence. It does not reproduce protected personal history, the confidential presentence report, or any confidential statement-of-reasons form.

Guidelines Ruling and Calculation

The court overruled Serrano's objection to the three-level adjustment under U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b). It found by a preponderance that he managed or supervised Alina Pared, one of exactly five criminally responsible participants, for a defined portion of the conspiracy.

The finding was limited to management or supervision of Pared as a person. The court did not find that Serrano supervised Corin Bell, Darius Venn, or Nessa Holt, and it did not rely on management of assets, property, or activities alone. The separate public order supplies the open reasons for that ruling without disclosing sealed presentence material.

Using the 2025 Guidelines Manual, the court adopted total offense level 20 and criminal history category I, producing an advisory imprisonment range of 33 to 41 months. The alternative without the adjustment would have been level 17 and 24 to 30 months. The court treated the adopted range as advisory and proceeded to consider 18 U.S.C. § 3553(a).

Public Reasons for the Sentence

The court considered the seriousness of knowing participation in a conspiracy to submit false reimbursement claims for services not performed, the charged period from August 4 through November 2, 2025, the stipulated \$186,400 loss, and the five-person scope. No transaction mechanics or reusable offense details are included here.

Mitigating considerations included acceptance of responsibility, criminal history category I, treatment progress, stable lawful work, caregiving, and prepared remorse. The court gave those subjects weight without exposing protected personal information. It also accounted for the limited character of the role finding, which concerned Pared alone rather than direction of the entire conspiracy.

The court concluded that 24 months, as requested by the defense, would understate the sustained conduct and supervisory responsibility. It selected 36 months, as requested by the government, within the 33-to-41-month range. The court found that term sufficient but not greater than necessary to provide punishment, promote respect for law, deter similar conduct, and support lawful reentry with supervision.

Terms Pronounced in Open Court

Judge Venn imposed 36 months of imprisonment on Count One, followed by three years of supervised release. Standard and mandatory conditions will appear in the written judgment, together with tailored provisions supporting treatment, lawful employment, truthful reporting, and restitution administration.

Restitution was ordered in the stipulated amount of \$186,400 to Meridian Community Supply Cooperative. The mandatory special assessment is \$100. No fine was imposed because available resources should be directed toward restitution. This summary contains no genuine payee address, account, routing information, custody designation, or reporting location.

The court noted defense counsel's preserved objection to the role adjustment and rejected the requested variance. After sentencing, it advised Serrano that any notice of appeal must ordinarily be filed within 14 days after entry of judgment, subject to the plea agreement. Judgment was scheduled for entry February 25. These public terms reflect the oral pronouncement; the written judgment controls its own administrative language.

Scope and Certification of This Summary

This document is a public minute entry and concise reasons summary. It is expressly not the confidential statement-of-reasons form and does not purport to reproduce, redact, or replace that form. It also is not a public presentence report.

Tessa Wren certifies that DE38 accurately records the February 24 hearing's participants, role ruling, advisory calculation, public statutory reasons, sentence, and sequence concerning the omitted personal allocution. The complete hearing transcript is separately recorded as DE37. Protected sentencing submissions remain in their sealed exercise volumes with category-only public surrogates.

Every party, office, identifier, and event is fictional. No real court record, personal history, account, credential, or confidential filing is included. The certification is limited to what occurred in the synthetic district proceeding through entry of this minute summary. It states no conclusion about a possible appeal, no later remedy, and no prediction regarding the continuing effect of the sentence.